



Polymarket

The largest global prediction market —
now entering the United States under CFTC regulatory clearance

FOUNDER SECONDARY · MARCH 2026

\$9Bn

Series D – Led by ICE (Oct '25)

\$7Bn

Monthly Volume (Feb '26)

~\$100Bn+

2026 Proj. Volume (Feb '26 RR)

ID8 TRANSACTION SUMMARY

ID8 is offering access to Polymarket founder shares at ~\$10.25Bn implied valuation (14% premium to last primary round of \$9Bn). This represents a discount to the current secondary market price of \$11–12Bn, and ~30% below the anticipated next round of ~\$15Bn.

Fees: 2% (legal / accounting setup fee) + 20% carry (15% for existing fund investors).

INVESTORS

Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) · Founders Fund (Thiel) · Valor Equity Partners · Coinbase Ventures · Point72 Ventures · Ribbit Capital · General Catalyst · 1789 Capital · Polychain Capital · Vitalik Buterin · Naval Ravikant

FOUNDER

Shayne Coplan, CEO · NYU CS dropout · Founded Polymarket 2020 age 22 · Youngest self-made billionaire (Bloomberg, Oct 2025) · ~11% stake

KEY ADVISORS

J. Christopher Giancarlo, Advisory Board Chair · Former Chair, U.S. CFTC · **Donald Trump Jr.**, Advisory Board

WHY NOW

CFTC Amended Order of Designation ↗

November 2025 — Polymarket received CFTC clearance after acquiring QCEX for \$112M. First legal U.S. access in 3 years.

Fee monetization launched ↗

February 2026 — First taker fees after 5 years at zero. Projected \$1Bn+ annualized revenue at current volumes.

2026 World Cup + U.S. Midterms ↗

Both confirmed Polymarket partnership events — two of the largest volume events in prediction market history still ahead.

Primary round forthcoming ↗

Kalshi just closed \$22Bn (Coatue, Mar 19). Polymarket next — secondary implied \$11.6Bn (PM Insights). Entry ~30% below Polymarket's reported ~\$15–\$20Bn target.

Company Overview

Polymarket is the largest prediction market in the world by cumulative volume — \$62 billion processed since founding, with a record \$7 billion in February 2026 alone. The platform lets users trade binary outcome contracts (priced \$0–\$1) on real-world events across elections, sports, economics, geopolitics, and culture, settled automatically via USDC stablecoin on the Polygon blockchain. Unlike traditional sportsbooks, Polymarket takes no directional risk — it is a peer-to-peer exchange where the crowd sets prices, proven more accurate than polls (2024 U.S. election, 2025 Nobel Prize, Federal Reserve decisions).

Polymarket operated offshore following a 2022 CFTC settlement. In July 2025 it acquired QCEX — a CFTC-licensed clearinghouse — for \$112M, receiving a CFTC Amended Order of Designation in November 2025. DOJ and CFTC investigations were dropped in July 2025 with no charges. ICE (NYSE parent, led \$2Bn investment round, Oct 2025) is the exclusive global distributor of Polymarket event-driven data to institutional trading desks.

WHAT TRADES ON POLYMARKET

Politics & Elections	Global elections, policy outcomes — \$3.3Bn wagered on 2024 U.S. presidential election alone
Sports	NFL, NBA, UFC, MLB (official partner), soccer — over 60% of open interest as of early 2026
Economics & Finance	Fed decisions, CPI, employment data — core use case for institutional and hedge fund clients
Geopolitics	Iran war, ceasefire timelines, leadership changes — highest profile and most contested category
Culture & Entertainment	Oscars, Emmys, Spotify rankings, social media events

REGULATORY POSITION

Polymarket received CFTC regulatory clearance in November 2025 after acquiring QCEX for \$112M. ICE's \$2Bn investment (Oct 2025) provides both institutional backing and global data distribution rights. The platform faces mirror state-level litigation to Kalshi — Nevada filed a civil complaint in January 2026.

CFTC Amended Order of Designation (Nov 2025)

Polymarket acquired QCEX for \$112M in July 2025, securing CFTC regulatory standing. Full U.S. rollout underway in 2026 — the first time U.S. users can legally access Polymarket in nearly 3 years.

FBI Investigation — Fully Resolved (July 2025)

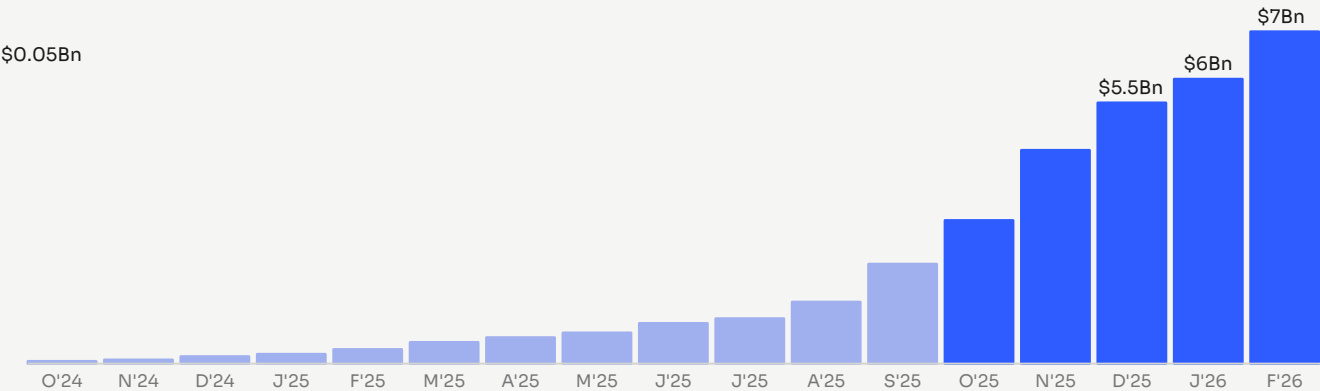
FBI raided Coplan's apartment in November 2024. Both DOJ and CFTC investigations were dropped in July 2025 with no charges filed. Regulatory cloud fully cleared.

ICE as Strategic Backer & Data Distributor

ICE is the exclusive global distributor of Polymarket event-driven data to institutional investors. The "Polymarket Signals and Sentiment" tool launched February 2026, feeding Wall Street trading desks.

Growth Validated by Data

Note: Polymarket did not charge trading fees until February 2026 and has not publicly disclosed revenue figures.



FINANCIAL SNAPSHOT

Metric	KALSHI	POLYMARKET	Notes
Monthly Volume (Feb 2026)	\$9.9Bn	\$7.9Bn	Public reports
Full-Year 2026 Volume (Estimated)	~\$120Bn	~\$100Bn	Assumes modest growth from current volumes
Take Rate	1.25%	0.8-1.25% (Assumed)	Convergence over time but zero fee model may persist partially
2026 Annualized Revenue Run-Rate	\$1.5Bn (Feb '26)	\$0.8-1.25Bn (Implied)	Implied revenue as fees implemented across platform
Valuation	~\$22Bn	~\$10.25Bn (at Purchase Price)	Polymarket reportedly in talks to raise at ~\$15-\$20Bn
Revenue Multiple	~15x	~8.25-12.25x (Implied)	New round will bring multiple parity

55x

Volume Growth

Jan 2024 →
Oct 2025

\$3.3Bn

2024 Election Bets

Single event
record

\$7Bn

Record Monthly Volume

February 2026

450K+

Active Traders

Early 2026

\$62Bn+

Cumulative Volume

All time · Mar
2026

70%+

Decentralized Market Share

Of global
pred. market
vol · Sacra

Market Opportunity & Risk Considerations

\$100Bn

2035 Prediction Market TAM

Prediction markets are gaining traction as financial infrastructure. Polymarket and Kalshi together hold 85–97% of global prediction market volume. Polymarket is the dominant international platform, now re-entering the United States — the world's largest gambling and derivatives market.

MARKET OUTLOOK

U.S. Market Re-Entry (2026)

Polymarket is re-entering the U.S. for the first time since 2022. Beta testing accumulated \$761M in cumulative notional volume in its first weeks. World Cup and midterms are immediate catalysts.

Fee Monetization Inflection

Polymarket operated at zero fees for 5 years to maximize liquidity. Taker fees launched February 2026. Projected \$1Bn+ annualised at current and projected volumes.

ICE Data Distribution — Institutional Moat

ICE is the exclusive global distributor of Polymarket event-driven data to institutional trading desks. "Polymarket Signals and Sentiment" tool launched February 2026. Data licensing carries near-pure profit margins.

Secondary Window — ~\$15Bn Round Ahead

WSJ (March 7, 2026): Polymarket in early-stage discussions targeting \$20Bn valuation. Secondary markets currently implied \$11.5-12Bn. Entry at ID8 purchase prices offers ~30% discount to next-round target.

RISKS & MITIGANTS

Regulatory Risk	Ongoing clashes between CFTC (federal oversight) and states (multiple lawsuits and court actions to ban service). Mitigated by CFTC asserting exclusive federal jurisdiction, Trump administration support, and QCEX acquisition providing regulatory standing.
Market Integrity	High-profile cases of “insider” or “wash sales” spark DOJ/SDNY scrutiny, CFTC warnings, and potential enforcement for insider trading or manipulation. Mitigated by Palantir/TWG AI sports integrity platform, Blockchain transparency and fees that disincentivise self-matched trades.
Blockchain Infrastructure	USDC peg impairment or Polygon disruption would halt settlement platform-wide. The \$850K nuclear detonation contract (Mar 2026) showed how disputed oracle inputs become operational crises. Mitigated by USDC's institutional credibility and Polygon's uninterrupted track record.
Monetization Risk	\$1Bn+ potential ARR is a third-party estimate applied to reported volume, not confirmed by Polymarket. Volume is Super Bowl and election-cycle-concentrated. Mitigated by ICE's high-margin data distribution agreement and POLY token as a second revenue lever.
Geopolitical & Content Risk	Contracts on wars and political deaths have drawn legislative attention — Reps. Moore and Carbajal introduced a ban bill in March 2026. Continued controversy risks ICE and Dow Jones partnership damage. Mitigated by Polymarket's willingness to delist, and by Kalshi facing identical exposure — this is a sector-wide risk.